

Vertigo

No 816 April 2018



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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Dawn view north to Mt Baldy from 1,460m on the Arthur Range,
Kahurangi National Park. More [here](#)

Chair's Report

April 2018

Bill Gates apparently said that “By the time we see that climate change is really bad, your ability to fix it is extremely limited... The carbon gets up there, but the heating effect is delayed. And then the effect of that heat on the species and ecosystem is delayed. That means that even when you turn virtuous, things are actually going to get worse for quite a while”. He, like many others, understates the issue. I spent most of my professional life working in disaster management, the evidence and consequence of climate change is especially powerful when you witness it first hand. If you don't think you have witnessed it first hand.... been on any glaciers in the South Island lately? You could save yourself a trip and watch [Chasing Ice](#) for a visceral exposé of how fast it is occurring. What are we doing about this? As little as possible from what I can see. In fact, we are hurrying along our demise as fast as we can. Nick Bostrom leaves Bill Gates for dead when he describes us as ‘Far from being the smartest possible biological species, we are probably better thought of as the stupidest possible biological species capable of starting a technological civilisation - a niche we filled because we got there first, not because we are in any sense optimally adapted to it.’ Technology won't save us, we will actually have to take action ourselves. If, as Gates predicts, we wait until it's really bad, we will be way too late. Chasing Ice shows that we are very close if not already there.

What are we doing about this. Seth Stephens-Davidowitz crunched some data and found out, so I'll wrap this up with a quote from his book, Everybody Lies: Big Data, New Data, and What the Internet Can Tell Us About Who We Really Are: “Walmart uses data from sales in all their stores to know what products to shelve. Before Hurricane Frances, a destructive storm that hit the Southeast in 2004, Walmart suspected, correctly, that people's shopping habits may change when a city is about to be pummeled by a storm. They pored through sales data from previous hurricanes to see what people might want to buy. A major answer? Strawberry Pop-Tarts. This product sells seven times faster than normal in the days leading up to a hurricane. Based on their analysis, Walmart had trucks loaded with strawberry Pop-Tarts heading down Interstate 95 toward stores in the path of the hurricane. And indeed, these Pop-Tarts sold well. Why Pop-Tarts? Probably because they don't require refrigeration or cooking. Why strawberry? No clue. But when hurricanes hit, people turn to strawberry Pop-Tarts apparently. So in the days before a hurricane, Walmart now regularly stocks its shelves with boxes upon boxes of strawberry Pop-Tarts. The reason for the relationship doesn't matter. But the relationship itself does. Maybe one day food scientists will figure out the association between hurricanes and toaster pastries filled with strawberry jam. But, while waiting for some such explanation, Walmart still needs to stock its shelves with strawberry Pop-Tarts when hurricanes are approaching and save the Rice Krispies treats for sunnier days.” Our solution to climate change: make more Strawberry Pop-Tarts.

If you have any comments on what you like or don't like send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us [@NZACWellington](https://twitter.com/NZACWellington).

Simon

From the Editor

As we go into another winter there are some important events now looming up

- Banff Wellington, an avalanche awareness course and the annual Snow Craft courses. [Read more.](#)

Thanks for the latest trip reports and images. Please keep em coming. Just type up a report of between half a page to three pages as a Word document, email it to me at occasionalclimber@gmail.com with one to six jpeg images and I'll format it for Vertigo.

Don't forget the page quicklinks at the base of each page - they let you go straight to the page you want rather than having to scroll back and forth all the time.

Peter

Simon Williamson
Chair: NZAC Wellington

Section News

May Section night

From 6pm Wed 30th May, Marcus Thomas will present his spectacular Cave book.

All Section night talks are held at The Third Eye, Tuatara Brewery, level 2.

Section nights beyond May

From 6pm Wed 27th June, Steven Fortune will take us on some new routes in Khumbu, Nepal. TBC

From 6pm Wed 25th July, Ross Cullen will take us through three years of Norwegian scrambling and climbing.

From 6pm Wed 29th August, it's the annual Wellington Section Photo competition judging evening.

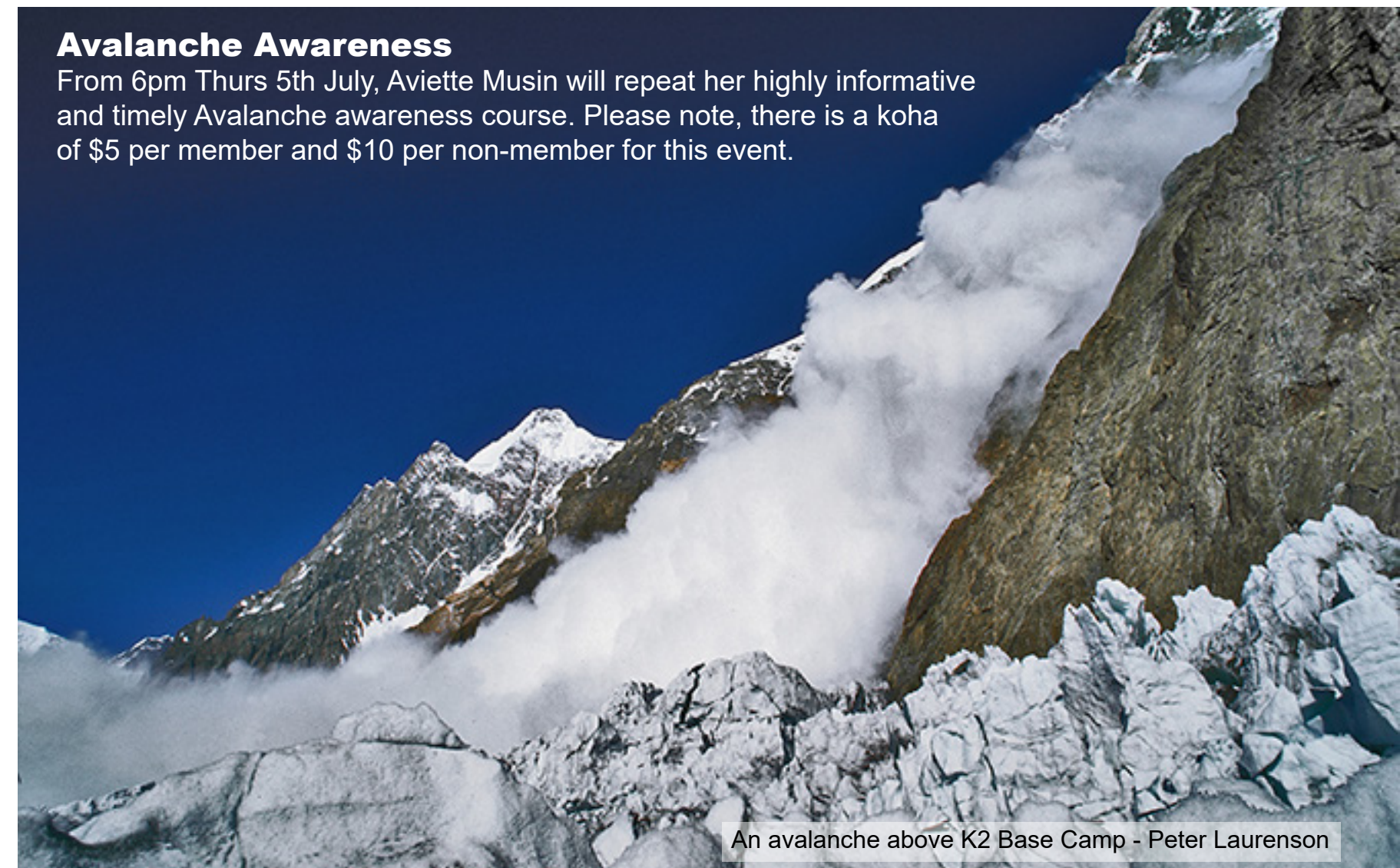
From 6pm Wed 26th September, Penny Webster will take us through her quest to climb all of New Zealand's 3,000m peaks.

From 6pm Wed 31st October, Nigel Roberts will present his journey up the highest peaks in each of USA's 50 states.

From 6pm Wed 28th November, Nina Sawicki will take us on a journey to Kanchenjunga base camp in Nepal.

Avalanche Awareness

From 6pm Thurs 5th July, Aviette Musin will repeat her highly informative and timely Avalanche awareness course. Please note, there is a koha of \$5 per member and \$10 per non-member for this event.



An avalanche above K2 Base Camp - Peter Laurenson

Section News

Gear Hire

Don't forget the Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level).

To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#).

Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return.

A little bit of advance notice would be appreciated as gear often needs to be retrieved from the gear store in Lower Hutt. Gear collections and drop-offs are usually available in the city during the working day or at section night.

Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Our snowcraft courses for the past few years have been run out of the Manawatu Tramping and Skiing Club lodge on Whakapapa. We're always made to feel welcome and the lodge is well situated a short walk from the top of the Bruce Road. Membership to the club is extremely reasonable - \$35 per year or \$50 for a family membership. Members stay at the lodge for \$36 a night including food. If you're looking for somewhere to base yourself for your winter pursuits or rock-climbing over the summer months go to www.mtsc.org.nz/joining.php to find out more about joining the club.

Notices

LandSAR rescue chopper possibly ceasing operation in CNI

Read [more](#). Sign a [petition](#) to retain it.

XII ISMM World Congress On Mountain Medicine

21-24 November 2018, Kathmandu, Nepal, www.ismm2018.org, [email](#)

NZAC 2018 calendars now on sale

Order [here](#). Please note buying online will have postage added at the checkout.

Broken River Skifield – Winter 2018 Member Discount

A new discount for NZAC members is now available for the upcoming season. Find out more [here](#).

International Snow Science Workshop preliminary programme [here](#)

American Alpine Club 2018 International Climbers' Meet, Yosemite Valley

The American Alpine Club is hosting its 10th annual International Climbers' Meet (ICM), to be held the week of Oct 7th - Oct 14th, 2018 in Yosemite Valley. There will be three days of education programming, host climbers available for guidance, and, per usual, an international cast of characters that will be crushing Yosemite. More [here](#).

UIAA ice climbing season

The provisional calendar for the 2018 UIAA

Ice Climbing season is now in place. Read [more](#).

“Berg”, 1962-2002

Free to good home - German Alpine Club journals, “Berg”, 1962-2002 - in German. Contact Anne Braun-Elwert - climb@alpinerecreation.com

Most Wanted – Images

The Department of Conservation needs great photos of particular huts, campsites, tracks and places. Many of their web pages are text only, but a picture can say so much more. Please take a look at their [most-wanted list](#), then follow the guidelines to submit your pics.

NZAC also would like both recent and/or historical images of its huts and more prominent members for use online and elsewhere. External and Interior images greatly appreciated and can be emailed to [Margaret](#). Please check out the [Heritage area](#) of our website to see where we are lacking images and supply image credit details to confirm we have permission to publish.

Updating our Club's history

A request for any updates from Club history buffs out there. Please contact [Margaret](#) if you can fill in any details about past and current Presidents:

- Anyone know the dates of death for - Leonard Harper (Pres 1891); Frank Graham (Pres 1895); J T Meeson (Pres 1896 also his first name)?
- Any name/info on G J McCallum (Pres 1979) and Dr R G Cunninghame (Pres May-Aug 1981)?

Any missing name/date of passing details for our first 50yr Veterans, the Foundation Members who achieved 50yr status on the following [webpage](#)? Also if you are able to fill in any gaps from the PDF lists at the bottom of this webpage it would be greatly appreciated.



Heading to Mt Cupola, Nelson Lakes

Coming Trips, Courses, Events

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	What & where
7 - 14 June	Banff Mountain Film Festival 2018 Wellington Memorial Theatre, Victoria University, 1-21 Kelburn Parade, Kelburn 2 programmes - Blue and Red - Click to make your booking
	Blue Thursday 7 June
	Red Sunday 10 June
	Blue Monday 11 June Red Thursday 14 June
Thursday 5 July, from 6pm	Avalanche Awareness Course presented by Aviette Musin The Third Eye, Tuatara Brewery, level 2 - the ideal precursor to a Snowcraft Course or any winter alpine activities. Please note, there is a koha of \$5 per member and \$10 per non-member for this event
Friday 27 & Saturday 28 July	Beginner Winter Snowcraft Course
Friday 3 & Saturday 4 Aug	Beginner Winter Snowcraft Course
Friday 17 & Saturday 18 Aug	Beginner/Intermediate Winter Snowcraft Course
Friday 24 & Saturday 25 Aug	Intermediate/Advanced Winter Snowcraft Course To register for any of these courses click here or contact wellington@alpineclub.org.nz
13 - 27 April 2019	Wellington Section Trip to Arapiles Please email your expression of interest to Jenny Cossey Fly to Melbourne individually and leave by car in a group from Melbourne on Saturday 13th April. Returning by car to Melbourne on Saturday 27th April. Please note these are the two weeks of the NZ school holidays which includes Good Friday (19th April), Easter Monday (22nd April) and ANZAC Day (25th April). Please book your own air tickets early to suit you. The Wellington section will give a subsidy towards car hire for the trip for a maximum of ten section members who register with the trip organizer Jenny Cossey on a first come first served basis. The Wellington NZAC Committee have agreed to the following for this trip. 1 Proposed members must have been on at least one Welly section trip in the last few years. 2 Climbing insurance must be taken out. NZAC insurance is preferred. Insurance details to be send to the trip organiser no later than one month before flying. 3 There will be no tuition or mentoring by trip members at Arapiles. 4 Climbers must be self sufficient, provide their own trad gear and lead trad 16. 5 A \$50 bond payment is required, payable before November 30th 2018. 6 Other section members who wish to climb for a shorter period,or none climbing partners are welcome but will have to arrange their own transport to Arapiles.



Trip Reports

Bush Bash Thrash to “Bollock” Creek

Words and pictures Stacey Wong



Marie and Stacey battling through the flax

With November leaving unfinished projects and scores to settle, our Wellington team promptly rebooked their tickets back to seek redemption at Paine’s Ford. Unfortunately Cyclone Gita had other plans. Not wanting to deal with the dawn convoy going over Takaka Hill, our team decided to head West. South West. All the way to Bullock Creek in Punakaiki. After all, it was Scarlett’s last trip with us and the West Coast was the missing piece of her NZ adventure. Geared up and ready to climb; what we weren’t ready for was some classic West Coast Bush Bashing. With the previous storm washing out parts of the road obscuring the obvious entries to the crag, we entered through what we could have sworn was an entry path and we found ourselves bashing through the 3 metre high dense flax fields with Eric boldly going where clearly no man had gone before, throwing himself down in the flax in the effort to find/create the path that we were so adamant was there. With the spirit of adventure and determination to climb some rock we managed to find a crag, although it took us a few hours to actually figure out what crag that was.

Marie and Stacey, running on enthusiasm and flu medication, eyed up a beautiful layback “16” on some classic stacked limestone. With extreme effort and great determination they managed to switch out leads enough times amongst themselves to get 4 clips up before admitting defeat. But who can save these lost draws?!? Eric’s ears burned as he heard the pleas of these lost draws. Our knight in chalky armour danced up the rock making one more clip before admitting defeat and confirming our suspicions that this was not a 16. Closer to a 25. Whoops. RIP bail biner.

Being at an unfamiliar crag, we spent much of (see: most of) our first day just trying to get our bearings. The remainder of the day was spent drinking cups of tea and having chats. But that same ol’ spirit of adventure prevailed and a brave few embarked on a 5-pitch multi-pitch at The Arboretum and gave the rest of the team a show. And alas, at the end of pitch 4; Eric spied a proper access path, through a dried out river, which was much better than the flax bashing, post apocalyptic jungle we had come in through, our walk out time got slashed by a huge percentage and to the great delight of our tired climbers, we found markers! And yeah, a very straight forward access route.



Bullock Creek from the road

Day 2 fared better for the team, heading to Weka Wall in Punakaiki to crank out some moderate level quantity knocking out the entire crag before lunch. This crag proved to be the perfect wee crag for our team of mixed grade climbers with everyone tying into the sharp end for at least a couple of leads. But the best part had to be the three star, sorry...three metre access route from bumper to bolt. Then back to Bullock Creek to tackle the multi-pitches at Two Towers, whilst some would call what we did as gardening, we thoroughly enjoyed the laybacking, crimping, pulling, jamming, and chimneying on Bullocks finest, dustiest offerings. I don't think I've ever heard the phrase "The tree is in" so many times, nor have I ever been so thankful for a well placed mid-route tree on a climb for when you've run out of handholds. And special mention has to go to our wee birdy friends, the wildlife was stunning and the climbers and hikers must be scarce as we had many curious robins and wekas coming to see what these weird humans were doing.

The chaos that was Bullock Creek made for some very interesting rappels straight into the bushes and the fun game of: Try avoid the stinging nettles! Whether it be whilst belaying, walking, falling, climbing, or rappelling. It was a trip of many firsts for some people in our team. First multi-pitch, first rappel, first trad melt down, first time climbing a tree mid route, and plenty of pushing ourselves out of our comfort zones and just having a great time outdoors with a great group of people. So it all added up to a really great adventure and we all left grinning from ear to ear, exhausted but ecstatic, and vowing to come back for another crack at the crag.

We had perfect weather, perfect sunsets, and Jenny was ecstatic that the sandfly count was "O for Owsomely" low. Staying at Punakaiki beach camp was a real treat, the beach was a mere 20 metres away from our tents, and we had hot water and a full kitchen for a cheap as chips price. It's no Paine's Ford, but it really is something special in itself, I know I'll definitely be back.



Eric rescuing our gear on the 25 that was not a 16



Above - Marie and Matt at Weka Wall

Below - Matt, Scarlett, and Jenny climbing at Weka Wall



Trip evolution in the Kahurangi

Words and pictures Peter Laurenson

With some relief we unlinked from our last four man river fording formation. Now safely on the true left of Ellis River, we knew there was only the gravel of Baton Valley Road between us and a warm shower, dry clothes and a good feed in Nelson. The light drizzle had become persistent rain on the roof of Flanagan’s Hut the evening before. That morning the surging torrent beside the Hut, in the upper reaches of Baton River, had confirmed that we’d better get out before the rivers rose much further. It was day seven of what originally was to be an eight day tops and valleys wilderness route masterminded by Shaun Barnett. Our early exit was just the latest evolution we’d made in the past week to his plan.

There isn’t that much of New Zealand’s back country Shaun’s boots haven’t trodden, but his planned eight day route in the Kahurangi National Park would take him to some new territory. The entire route was new for me. Our entry point would be Baton Valley Road, heading over Baton Saddle to Karamea River, then up again over Sandy Peak and the Herbert Range, down and around the base of Mount Kendall to Trevor Carter Hut, up again to Biggs Tops, down to Stone Hut, up and over to Kiwi Saddle, up Mount Patriarch and then along the Arthur Range as far as John Reid Hut, finally exiting via the Wangapeka River Road. Quite a hike. Joining us were two of Shaun’s long time hill buddies Darryn Pegram and Steve Baker. Three of us are very keen photographers. Darryn used to be too but these days he’s happy to leave his camera gear behind. He became our super model, stalked by the paparazzi at every photogenic spot.

An initially favourable but deteriorating weather forecast prompted our first evolution to the plan. Shaun figured that, by reversing our route, we could get up onto the tops rapidly to enjoy the first four days of mild weather. By the afternoon of day four rain was expected and, beyond that, well who knows in this climate changing world. With packs over 20kgs, the initial climb up to John Reid Hut and then on to the southern end of the Arthur Range seemed pretty brutal. No pain no gain though and we certainly made a gain. For photographers, our bivvy spot at 1,463m that night, then the one two nights later on Biggs Tops, were visits to heaven.



Descending Nugget Knob

In sodden boots from crossing the Wangapeka River at our midday taxi van drop off point, it took about four hours to reach John Reid Hut at 1,240m. As soon as we entered the forest inquisitive little Robins flitted here and there, coming very close to check us out. During the next week I saw a greater variety and proliferation of native birdlife in one place than ever before. Robins and Weka everywhere. Blue ducks, Fantail, Tui, Bellbird, Kereru, Tomtit, Kea, Kakariki. Normally you need to pause and tune in to hear birdsong in our forests, but not this time – it was constantly all around us. I’m told that Kahurangi National Park is one of the areas longest receiving 1080 drops. Our experience seemed anecdotal proof that it’s working.

Up at John Reid Hut a friendly party of local tramping club members were busy refurbishing both inside and out. With them and the weka it was busy, but we only lingered there to have dinner and replenish our water supplies before heading up onto the ridge, part of the Arthur Range, above the Hut. As darkness fell we settled into our tents and bivvy bags to enjoy a moody sunset. Dawn was even better. Parts of our intended route to the west emerged in mauve and pink hues, as the sun approached the horizon on our eastern side.

Darryn was first to set off about 8am, me being last to leave as gravity pestered my bowl. Another mandatory bivvy and hut weka emerged to see me off as I set off along an undulating ridge in the direction of Mount Patriarch. I caught the others up where they’d paused to watch a Kea and soak up a superb view of Patriarch. Our route down a spur to Kiwi Saddle Hut was also apparent.



Sunrise from our 1,463m campsite on the Arthur Range, spanning Mt Baldy (far left) and the Lookout Range to the east

At the saddle beneath Patriarch Darryn and Steve decided to go directly on to Kiwi Saddle while Shaun and I scampered pack less, up the 340 metres between us and Patriarch’s summit at 1,701m. On top we enjoyed superb 360 degree views and an opportunity to eyeball much of our intended route. We joined the others down at Kiwi Saddle Hut (1,000m) for lunch. The weight of our packs now played on our minds as we prepared to head on up again to a 1,400m saddle beneath Mount Luna.

As we made our way up towards the treeline, competing with the birdsong, a more sinister low hum became apparent - wasps. Sadly they were ever present in the Park and we would get to know them more personally in due course. Above the treeline we joined a narrow rocky ridge leading steeply up to a 1,400m point overlooking picturesque Luna Lake, some 200 metres lower down. From there we sidled around the east side of a 1,578m peak to reach the saddle beneath Mount Luna, also at 1,400m.

The saddle gave access to the head of Stone Creek, which we followed back down through exceptionally beautiful emerald moss-clad, water fall festooned forest to Stone Hut, back down at 700 metres. It had been a long 10.5 hour day. Shaun, wearing one of those fancy new step meter watch smart devices, reported “We’ve done 33,900 steps today, more than four times the World Health Organisations recommended daily amount.” Be that as it may, according to our schedule, by the end of day two we should have reached Trevor Carter Hut down at 500 metres, requiring another climb over 1,300 metre Biggs Tops to reach.

Our schedule was proving to be more ambitious than we’d thought. With deteriorating weather on its way, too ambitious. Time for another evolution! Instead of carrying on beyond Trevor Carter Hut to the Herbert Range, we reluctantly agreed to head east down the Karamea River and, weather permitting, enjoy some more tops travel above Baton Saddle. This also gave us good escape options if the weather really packed up. Decision made, we enjoyed a cosy evening in the hut.



Next morning dawned calm with high cloud, perfect hiking conditions as we pushed on to Wangapeka Saddle at 1,010m. From there we all dropped our packs and clambered up a steep slope onto the tops beneath Nugget Knob, a 1,505m high point. The summit proved to be further than expected, but well worth the effort for the views and the enjoyable, rocky, knife edged ridge beneath the summit. After lunch back down at the saddle, we shouldered our packs and headed on upwards again to Biggs Tops at 1,300m.

To secure a water supply for our bivvy site up on Biggs Tops, we had to abandon the poled route leading on to Trevor Carter Hut, branching right/east to a lovely tarn nestled in a small basin, arriving about 5pm after about seven hours of hiking. If anything, this spot was even more impressive than our first bivvy back on the Arthur Range. And the light show unfolding for us that evening definitely was. Godly shafts of light poured over the Scarlet Range, spotlighting areas otherwise in shadow beneath us. Dawn next morning was just as impressive and it was fun to share such photographically dreamlike conditions with the others. Normally I’m the only keen photographer on my trips, with my companions sometimes looking sideways at me as I rave on about the light and so on. Not this trip – we were like a litter of piglets in warm mud as we captured the moment.

If we’d followed the original plan we’d have missed all this tops action because, as day four wore on, the weather slowly began to deteriorate. As it was this wasn’t a problem because, once we dropped steeply off Biggs Tops to Trevor Carter Hut (500m), the next two days were all in the forest, tracing the Karamea River.

From Trevor Carter we meandered on to Thor Hut (450m), then further on to Venus Hut (390m). This was an easy six hour day and, below Venus Hut, is a lovely swimming hole where we washed away several days of grime and cooled off in the warmer river valley climate. The following day was similar as we carried on down river, past Crow Hut (330m) to Karamea Bend Hut (280m).



Sunset over the Scarlet Range and Mt Herbert, viewed from Biggs Tops

On our sixth day the rain began to set in. It was time to climb again, up to Baton Saddle over a 1,000 metres above. The previous two days had allowed us to rejuvenate, but we still weren't quite prepared for what confronted us on the lower section of the climb to the Saddle. At the trail junction with the Leslie Karamea Track, carved into the old sign stating "Baton Saddle via Wilkinson Track" was "Horror". Some other knowing soul had also penned "Total". At the time we chuckled but it wasn't long before, pouring with sweat, we were struggling up steep, slippery mud and boulders. To up the ante stinging nettles made an appearance and steadily proliferated. But wait, there's more ... wasps, nests of angry wasps.



At one point the combination of slippery exposed rock and stinging nettles became impassable. We were forced to abandon the semblance of a trail in favour of a semi-vertical, moss covered boulder field. I took a tumble into a cluster of nettles and, just as I thought we'd dealt with the worst of it, I looked up directly into a small round hole with wasps coming in and out of it. Oh shit – things went a bit silly as I tried to get as far past the hole, as quickly as I could. Sting to the leg, sting to the head, many expletives and flapping of hands. Then, no more stings – thank goodness for that. Shaun and Darryn were also stung. At least the gradient soon eased off and we left the nettles behind.

Up at about 1,000 metres we paused for lunch and antihistamines, before tackling a final steep 350 metre section leading to Baton Saddle at 1,340m. Up there clouds obscured much of the view – enough to shut down any thoughts of proceeding along the tops. Looking down the south side of the Saddle didn't fill us with joy though either – steep slippery tussock clods and a legion of spikey Spaniards. Slowly we picked our way down to a sodden wetland basin that eventually gave way again to forest. Soon we reached Flanagan's Hut (940m) – a little under eight hours after leaving Karamea Bend Hut, but a fairly intense eight hours nevertheless.

Eight bunk Flanagan's Hut is situated in a small clearing just 20 metres from Baton River, which is really just a stream at that altitude. The Hut exudes a certain charm lacking in some of the more modern huts in the Park and was a cosy place to stay that night, as the intensifying rain rattled on the roof.

On the morning of day seven a pair of rowdy weka woke us unceremoniously. Just as well though, because the extent to which Baton River had swollen, even beside the hut, left us in no doubt that time was of the essence. With all thoughts of a final stint on the tops a distant memory, we started our wet and slippery descent, which required half a dozen crossings of Baton River. It was fortunate we had four in our party, because our last couple of crossings required all four to bind together to safely ford the waist deep torrent. It was the most extensive swollen river experience I've had and I was mightily impressed at how stable a four, or even two man fording team actually is.

Wet and weary, we found ourselves on the true left bank of Ellis River about mid-afternoon. Shaun had our taxi van pickup all set, except that we were now a day early and hadn't been able to get a cell phone signal anywhere to bring our pickup forward. Nothing for it but to start walking the gravel of Baton Valley Road until we got a signal. Ah well, at least the drizzle had stopped. As it was, after a few kms of trudging a Ute appeared from the opposite direction. We flagged over the driver, a local farmer, to ask if he knew how far it was to a signal. "Not till the far end of the valley, fifteen or so kms away. But how about I drop this ram off (sitting in a cage on his Ute deck) and come back and drop you down there?" he explained "Hell yes!" was our reply. Definition of good sort!

Less than three hours later we were showered, changed into clean dry clothes and supping our first beers at a Nelson pub as the rain continued outside. With the benefit of hindsight we agreed that our trip evolutions had all been good calls. Whilst Shaun's step meter confirmed we'd taken about 180,000 steps and my altimeter indicated a cumulative height gain of 4,600 metres and descent of 4,200 metres, we still hadn't met all our objectives. But so what - the journey had been fantastic.



Beside the lower reaches of a rain swollen Baton River

For more images and a route map
www.occasionalclimber.co.nz

Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Role	Name	Contact
Chair person	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Secretary, gear custodian	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Treasurer	Vacant	
Trip co-ordinator	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Section nights, Vertigo, Photocomp	Peter Laurenson	021 446 725
Social media	Marie Kelly	
Club liaison	Keith Munro	
Library, Projects	Alex Waterworth	
General Committee	Matt Pemberton	
General Committee	Guy Dubuis	
General Committee	Joshua Mouat	
Patron	John Nankervis	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893



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New routes every week*

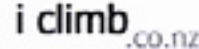
\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012
New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

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* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



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Ocelot	MXC 820	Makalu	Caiman
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For quick access to our Section's page on the NZAC website, click or scan this QR code



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- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
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Training

- * Level 1- 3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building lifelong friendships

... protecting and improving access to alpine places

... sustaining and growing climbing and mountaineering achievement

... enhancing alpine safety

... building appreciation, enjoyment and protection of alpine places